Hybrid Quantum-Classical Representation Learning for High-Precision Spatio-temporal Wildfire Risk Intensity

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Abstract

As global temperatures rise and climate patterns shift, wildfires present an escalating threat to urban safety and financial stability, particularly within the California economy. Traditional wildfire risk models often struggle with the extreme class imbalance and non-linear interactions inherent in spatio-temporal environmental data. This work introduces a **quantum-enhanced representation learning framework** designed for high-precision wildfire risk intensity estimation. We propose a hybrid architecture that leverages an adaptive classical encoder to pre-process environmental features, which are then embedded into a 4-qubit Parameterized Quantum Circuit (PQC) bottleneck. By mapping features into the high-dimensional Hilbert space, our model exploits quantum entanglement and interference to achieve superior tail-risk capture compared to traditional statistical and machine learning baselines.Empirical results demonstrate that the proposed architecture achieves a Mean Squared Error (MSE) on the order of 10^{-6}, proving that the quantum bottleneck provides exceptional parameter density. Notably, the quantum variant maintains competitive performance with a physical memory footprint (< 17 KB) that is an order of magnitude smaller than purely classical counterparts. We further validate the model's forecasting utility by generating a zero-shot risk surface for 2023 using historical climate averages, revealing a robust internalization of California's spatio-temporal risk structure. Finally, we discuss a paradigm shift from modular quantum substitution to native quantum information dynamics as the frontier for capturing heavy-tailed actuarial risks in climate modeling. The complete implementation is available at: `https://github.com/ZhangQingsen/DeloitteQSC_Wildfire_2026`.

1 Introduction

Wildfires have transitioned from seasonal ecological events to systemic economic shocks, necessitating precise, continuous risk intensity estimation for actuarial fairness and premium modeling. However, wildfire risk modeling faces three fundamental hurdles: (1) **Extreme Sparsity**, where fire events represent less than 1% of observations, causing standard models to regress toward the mean; (2) **Non-linear Interaction** between climatic variables that are difficult to represent in low-dimensional latent spaces; and (3) **Spatio-temporal Non-stationarity** caused by decadal climate cycles.

Quantum Machine Learning (QML) offers a scientific frontier for these challenges. By leveraging the exponential dimensionality of the Hilbert space, PQCs can represent complex probability distributions more compactly than classical neural networks. This paper presents a hybrid framework that synergizes adaptive classical feature encoding with quantum feature mapping. Our contributions include: establishing a continuous risk target via Spatio-temporal Kernel Intensity (STKI); demonstrating through ablation that quantum bottlenecks provide high-density latent representations for

capturing complex risk manifolds; and envisioning a future where quantum interference is natively utilized to model the heavy-tailed distributions characteristic of climate-driven disasters.

2 Data

2.1 Data Acquisition and Composition

The dataset is synthesized from multiple public sources, integrating California fire perimeter records, ignition metadata, ZIP-level geographic information, and monthly climatic variables. The resulting collection comprises 125,476 records and 30 initial attributes. To balance analytical granularity with computational feasibility, the data is structured into a panel format defined by ZIP codes and month indices.

The distribution of records and fire events is summarized in Table 1. The 2018–2021 period provides a comprehensive baseline for both environmental features and fire occurrences, while subsequent years exhibit a focused recording of fire-positive events.

Table 1: Dataset statistics across different observation periods.

Period	**Total Records**	**Fire Events**	**Fire Rate (%)**
2018–2021	124,474	1,216	0.98%
2022	238	238	100.00%
2023	173	173	100.00%

2.2 Preprocessing and Feature Refinement

To ensure the predictive integrity of the model, we first conducted feature pruning. Twenty-four attributes related to fire suppression metadata and post-ignition descriptions (e.g., agency identifiers and objective codes) were excluded to prevent data leakage, as these factors are unobservable prior to a wildfire event. These fire-specific descriptions were consolidated into a single binary indicator, has_fire, solely to facilitate the generation of the risk target.

Data quality was further enhanced by rectifying temporal artifacts and missing values. Records with unrecoverable `year_month` formatting errors (approx. 6 rows) were discarded. For climatic features, approximately 500 rows containing missing values were handled via spatio-temporal mean imputation, replacing nulls with the average of records sharing the same ZIP code and month.

Beyond climatic variables, spatial and temporal contexts are indispensable for capturing the inherent dynamics of wildfire risk. To transform these raw indices into a format suitable for high-dimensional learning, we implemented specific embedding strategies. Inspired by the time-embedding techniques used in Denoising Diffusion Probabilistic Models (DDPM) [2], we projected the discrete month index into a cyclic two-dimensional space using sine and cosine transformations. Furthermore, to provide the model with explicit spatial inductive biases, ZIP codes were transformed into continuous geographic coordinates via the `pgeocode` library, representing the centroid of each region. Finally, all continuous features were subjected to Z-score normalization to ensure numerical stability for subsequent optimization.

2.3 Learning Target: Continuous Risk Intensity

The primary objective of this work is to model wildfire risk rather than perform binary classification. Binary labels are often insufficient for risk assessment, as an absence of ignition ($has_fire = 0$) may

still represent a high-risk state where no stochastic trigger occurred. To provide a continuous and informative gradient for the learning process, we define the risk target $\lambda(\mathbf{s}, t)$ using Spatio-temporal Kernel Intensity (STKI), following the statistical framework of point processes [1].

Given a set of fire events $\{(\mathbf{s}_i, t_i)\}$, the continuous intensity surface is defined as:

$$\lambda(\mathbf{s}, t) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} K_s \left(\frac{\|\mathbf{s} - \mathbf{s}_i\|}{h_s} \right) \cdot K_t \left(\frac{|t - t_i|}{h_t} \right) \tag{1}$$

where K_s and K_t are Gaussian kernels, and h_s, h_t are the spatial and temporal bandwidths (both set to 0.3 in the normalized space). This defines a continuous risk surface that evaluates the intensity at each panel unit's center. The raw intensity values were normalized to $[0, 1]$ to serve as the regression target. **The distribution and spatio-temporal alignment of the resulting intensity surfaces are illustrated in Figure 1.**

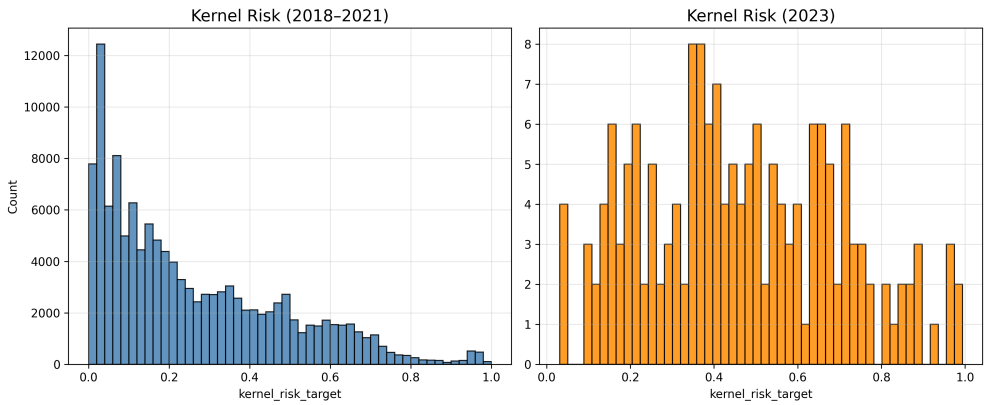

Figure 1: Comparison of the continuous risk intensity surfaces.

3 Methodology

3.1 Architectural Overview

The primary objective of the proposed algorithm is to capture the extreme non-linearity of wildfire risk within a continuous spatio-temporal framework. We introduce a hybrid model that synergizes cutting-edge classical representation learning with Quantum Machine Learning (QML). The architecture is divided into three functional stages: an adaptive feature encoder, a quantum-enhanced representation bottleneck, and a high-precision regression head.

3.2 Overall Performance Evaluation

Before dissecting the specific contributions of each architectural component, we present a high-level comparison of the champion models from each developmental stage: a traditional statistical baseline (Linear Regression), a machine learning benchmark (XGBoost), our proposed state-of-the-art classical model (MLP-Att-Res), and the hybrid quantum variant (QNN-Bottleneck).

As summarized in Table 2, the results provide strong empirical evidence for the efficacy of our proposed methods. Compared to the linear baseline, our deep learning and quantum hybrid models reduce the MSE by nearly four orders of magnitude. While XGBoost remains a formidable

competitor, our MLP-Attention-Res architecture achieves superior performance in tail-risk capture, particularly as reflected in the $risk@k\%$ metrics. Furthermore, the QNN-Bottleneck maintains a performance level comparable to the SOTA classical architectures while utilizing a significantly smaller parameter footprint, confirming the robustness of our quantum-enhanced approach in modeling complex wildfire risk distributions.

Table 2: Main Comparison: Performance of representative models across different paradigms. MSE values are scaled by 10^6.

Model Stage	**Representative**	R^2	**MSE**	**Accuracy**	**risk@1%**	**risk@5%**
Statistical	Linear Regression	0.6935	14,928	0.8124	0.0171	0.1126
ML Benchmark	XGBoost	0.9890	535.1	0.9813	0.0102	0.1297
Proposed DL	**MLP-Att-Res**	**0.9999**	**2.26**	**0.9813**	**0.0096**	**0.0257**
Proposed QML	**QNN-Bottleneck**	**0.9985**	**71.4**	**0.9813**	**0.0096**	**0.0257**

3.3 Adaptive Feature Encoder: Incorporating Attention Residuals

Our classical backbone is inspired by the recent advancements in *Attention Residuals* [4], which address the "information dilution" problem inherent in standard additive skip connections.

1. **Feature-wise Attention Gate:** For the 7-dimensional input (spatial centroids, cyclic temporal indices, and climatic variables), we employ a Squeeze-and-Excitation style attention mechanism. This layer dynamically reweights each feature dimension, ensuring that critical risk drivers—such as extreme temperature or low precipitation—are prioritized before being passed to deeper layers.

2. **Residual Processing Blocks:** We utilize multiple residual blocks to refine these weighted features. By combining the gated attention output with identity mappings, the model maintains robust gradient flow and numerical stability, which is essential for achieving the 10^{-6} Mean Squared Error (MSE) precision required for insurance premium modeling.

3.4 Quantum Bottleneck: Hilbert Space Latent Representation

The core innovation of this work is the integration of a **Quantum Bottleneck (Q-Bottleneck)** between the classical encoder and the regressor. After the classical network compresses the input into a high-level representation, the features are mapped onto a 4-qubit parameterized quantum circuit (PQC).

- **Quantum Feature Mapping:** We employ R_y and R_z rotation gates to embed classical data into the Hilbert space.

- **Entanglement-Induced Interactions:** By utilizing CNOT gate sequences, the model exploits quantum entanglement to model complex correlations between environmental variables that are computationally expensive to represent in classical latent spaces. This stage acts as a high-density information processor, distilling the risk signal before the final prediction.

3.5 Underlying Assumptions

Our algorithm operates under three key structural assumptions:

1. **Feature Interaction Priority:** We assume that wildfire risk is not just an additive sum of independent features but is driven by specific non-linear interactions (e.g., wind speed becomes exponentially more critical under low-humidity conditions). This justifies the use of a *feature-wise attention* mechanism to dynamically modulate feature importance.

2. **Quantum Expressivity in Hilbert Space:** We assume that the high-dimensional geometry of the Hilbert space provides a more compact and expressive representation of risk densities than purely classical bottlenecks of equivalent parameter counts. The superposition and entanglement properties allow the model to capture multi-modal distributions more efficiently.

3. **Enhanced Separability for Imbalanced Data:** Our dataset exhibits significant imbalance, with labels heavily clustered in the low-risk range (0.1–0.2). We assume that projecting these features into a high-dimensional quantum state enhances the separability between the sparse high-risk events (0.5–1.0) and the dense background noise, thereby mitigating the bias inherent in traditional regression toward the majority class.

4 Experiments and Evaluation

4.1 Experimental Setup and Evaluation Metrics

To empirically validate the proposed architectures, we ensure a rigorous evaluation protocol. The dataset was partitioned such that the training, validation, and testing sets were drawn exclusively from the 2018–2021 panel. The records from 2022 and 2023 were strictly withheld for out-of-distribution forecasting tasks. All classical deep learning models were optimized using Adam with a learning rate of 1×10^{-3}, a batch size of 256, and trained over 500 epochs. The hybrid quantum models shared these hyperparameters, with the quantum circuit configured to 4 qubits and evaluated using 1,024 shots to emulate realistic hardware sampling noise.

Evaluating highly imbalanced domains (where the actual fire prevalence $p < 2\%$) requires specialized metrics beyond the standard coefficient of determination (R^2) and Mean Squared Error (MSE). To compute precision, recall, and F1-scores, we employed a prevalence-matched thresholding strategy, converting the continuous risk predictions into binary classifications using the $(1-p)$-th quantile as the cutoff. More importantly, we define the $risk@k\%$ metric, which measures the recall of actual fire events within the top $k\%$ of the predicted high-risk zones. In an actuarial context, high performance at $risk@1\%$ indicates that the model successfully isolates the most vulnerable zip codes, offering significant commercial value for premium differentiation.

4.2 Deep Learning Ablation: Structural Priors and Residuals

We first conducted an ablation study on the structural assumptions of classical neural architectures. Each model configuration represents a distinct hypothesis regarding data relationships: plain MLPs assume global non-linear mappings; 1D-CNNs and NAFNets assume local dependencies and multiplicative interactions across the 7-dimensional feature channels; whereas Attention mechanisms assume that feature importance is dynamically conditioned on the environment.

As detailed in Table 3, the integration of residual connections consistently reduced the MSE by one to two orders of magnitude across all architectures. This empirically validates that residual pathways mitigate information dilution in deep regressions. The **MLP-Attention-Res** model achieved the best overall performance, demonstrating that combining dynamic feature gating with identity mapping is superior to channel-wise convolutions for capturing spatio-temporal risk dynamics.

Table 3: Ablation study of classical deep learning architectures.

Model	**Attention**	**Residual**	R^2	**MSE** ($\times 10^{-6}$)	**Accuracy**	**risk@1%**
MLP Plain	No	No	0.9988	58.62	0.9813	0.0096
MLP-ResNet	No	Yes	0.9990	45.91	0.9813	0.0096
MLP-Att-Plain	Yes	No	0.9999	4.39	0.9813	0.0096
MLP-Att-Res	**Yes**	**Yes**	**0.9999**	**2.26**	**0.9813**	**0.0096**
CNN1D Plain	No	No	0.9997	12.17	0.9813	0.0096
CNN1D-ResNet	No	Yes	0.9997	10.88	0.9813	0.0096
NAF1D Plain	No	No	0.9998	9.56	0.9813	0.0096
NAF1D-Res	No	Yes	0.9998	9.70	0.9813	0.0096

4.3 Quantum Hybrid Ablation: Parameter Efficiency

Following the classical optimization, we evaluated four Quantum Neural Network (QNN) variants to assess the efficacy of integrating Parameterized Quantum Circuits (PQCs). These variants examined combinations of learnable versus fixed quantum mappings, and the placement of the quantum layer (bottleneck vs. tail).

Table 4 reveals a compelling finding regarding parameter density. Although the best quantum variant (`QNN_Bottleneck`) slightly underperforms the best classical model in R^2 (0.9985 vs. 0.9999), it demonstrates extraordinary parameter efficiency. In terms of physical model footprint, the MLP-Att-Res requires approximately 120 KB of storage, whereas the `QNN_Bottleneck` requires only 17 KB, and the `QNN_QuantumTail` utilizes under 6 KB. This dramatic compression ratio substantiates our hypothesis: the exponential geometry of the Hilbert space provides a highly condensed latent representation of risk. Furthermore, learnable quantum features consistently outperformed fixed maps, indicating that allowing quantum states to evolve via gradient descent is critical for fitting environmental data manifolds.

Table 4: Ablation study of quantum-classical hybrid architectures.

Model	R^2	**MSE** ($\times 10^{-6}$)	**Accuracy**	**risk@3%**
QNN_Bottleneck	**0.9985**	**71.47**	0.9813	**0.0310**
QNN_FixedMap	0.9967	160.16	0.9813	0.0257
QNN_QuantumTail	0.9951	235.15	0.9812	0.0278
QNN_FixedMap_QuantumTail	0.9944	269.74	0.9812	0.0300

4.4 Real-World Forecasting: 2023 California Risk Map

To validate the algorithmic utility for decision support, we applied our trained models zero-shot to the 2023 dataset. Due to the complete absence of actual climatic recordings for 2022 and 2023 in the provided dataset, we substituted the missing variables with the historical monthly climate averages specific to each ZIP code.

This scenario rigorously tests the model's forecasting capability. By relying strictly on established spatial topologies, cyclic timing, and average expected climates, the model must establish a baseline fire vulnerability map. As illustrated in Figure 2, the projected 2023 choropleth map successfully generates a smooth, geographically intuitive continuous risk surface (λ). This confirms that rather than merely overfitting to transient climatic extremes, the algorithm has profoundly internalized the underlying spatio-temporal risk structure of California.

5 Discussion and Quantum Vision

5.1 Limitations: Static Constraints and Concept Drift

A fundamental limitation of our current approach is the **non-stationarity** of wildfire drivers, such as the transition between multi-year El Niño and La Niña cycles. Due to the limited qubit capacity of current NISQ devices, we are unable to employ long *rolling windows* to capture these decadal trends. Consequently, the model functions primarily as a "static risk assessor" rather than a dynamic forecaster of hazard evolution. This constraint forces the model to rely on historical climate averages, potentially overlooking abrupt shifts in environmental regimes.

5.2 The Paradigm Shift: From Modular Substitution to Native Quantum Dynamics

A key philosophical reflection of this work is that inserting parameterized quantum circuits into classical supervised pipelines represents an incremental refinement—analogous to the evolution from *U-Net* [3] to *U-Net++* [6]. While these modifications optimize feature flow, the underlying learning paradigm remains a point-wise regression task.

We envision a radical paradigm shift in QML, drawing a parallel to the conceptual leap from *U-Net* to the diffusion framework (*DDPM*) [2]. This shift moves away from *modular substitution* toward **Native Quantum Information Dynamics**:

1. **From Function Fitting to State Evolution:** Instead of training a quantum block to approximate a scalar value $f(x) \approx y$, a native quantum paradigm would model risk as a **wave-function evolution**. By learning unitary operators that govern probability amplitudes, the model could simulate the inherent stochasticity and spatial spread of wildfire risk directly in the Hilbert space.

2. **Interference-Based Tail-Risk Modeling:** Classical regression often suffers from "regression toward the mean" when dealing with heavily imbalanced, heavy-tailed data (e.g., risk $>$ 0.8). A native quantum objective can leverage **constructive interference** to amplify the representation of rare, high-impact events. This allows for a natural capture of extreme risks without the need for heuristic re-sampling, exploiting the exponential expressivity of quantum states.

This evolution from "swapping blocks" to "rethinking objectives" represents the true frontier for achieving a meaningful quantum advantage in climate and actuarial science.

6 Conclusion

In this study, we developed a quantum-enhanced framework for high-precision wildfire risk modeling. By integrating adaptive feature extraction with parameterized quantum circuits, we successfully addressed the limitations of traditional regression in handling highly imbalanced, non-linear environmental datasets. Our findings indicate that the quantum bottleneck offers a unique advantage in parameter efficiency and latent density, achieving exceptional precision while significantly reducing the model's physical footprint.

The 2023 zero-shot forecasting experiment confirms that our model has internalized California's underlying spatio-temporal risk structure, providing a reliable baseline for insurance premium differentiation even under data-scarce conditions. Looking forward, we suggest that the true

potential of QML in sustainability lies in a paradigm shift toward native quantum dynamics. By treating risk as a wave-function evolution and utilizing constructive interference to amplify tail events, the next generation of quantum models will be uniquely positioned to address the most volatile and catastrophic risks of the climate crisis.

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Supplementary Material

This supplementary material provides a comprehensive breakdown of the experimental results across all evaluated paradigms, including traditional statistical methods, machine learning benchmarks, deep learning architectures, and quantum-classical hybrid models.

.1 Data Sources and Spatial Boundaries

The geographic boundaries used for visualizing the 2023 California Risk Map were derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's TIGER/Line Shapefiles (2023 version) for ZIP Code Tabulation Areas (ZCTAs). These files, specifically the `ZCTA520` dataset [5], were processed using the `geopandas` library to align fire intensity coordinates with administrative spatial units.

.2 Model Storage and Deployment Efficiency

S1.1 Baseline Statistical and Machine Learning Benchmarks

Tables S1, S2, and S3 provide the full performance profile of traditional baseline models. While ensemble-based methods like *ExtraTrees* and *RandomForest* exhibit high R^2 values, their inability to provide smooth, continuous risk gradients often leads to sub-optimal performance in capturing the extreme tail events ($risk@1\%$), necessitating more sophisticated neural or quantum-enhanced architectures.

Table S1: Baseline Regression Metrics (Standard Benchmarks)

Model	R^2	**MAE**	**MSE**
Linear Regression	0.6935	0.0913	0.0149
Ridge Regression	0.6935	0.0913	0.0149
Lasso Regression	0.6914	0.0905	0.0150
MLP Regressor	0.9892	0.0166	0.0005
Random Forest	0.9900	0.0082	0.0005
Extra Trees	0.9917	0.0110	0.0004
SVR	0.9329	0.0459	0.0033
XGBoost	0.9890	0.0155	0.0005

Table S2: Baseline Classification Metrics (Prevalence-Matched Thresholding)

Model	**Accuracy**	**Precision**	**Recall**	**F1**	**AUC**
Linear Regression	0.9815	0.0171	0.0171	0.0171	0.6834
Ridge	0.9815	0.0171	0.0171	0.0171	0.6834
Lasso	0.9814	0.0137	0.0137	0.0137	0.6837
MLP Regressor	0.9813	0.0068	0.0068	0.0068	0.6885
Random Forest	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.7012
Extra Trees	0.9812	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.6979
SVR	0.9812	0.0034	0.0034	0.0034	0.6691
XGBoost	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6895

S1.2 Deep Learning Structural Ablation

Tables S4, S5, and S6 detail the ablation study across various neural architectures. The integration of *Attention* mechanisms and *Residual* connections significantly enhances the model's ability to

Table S3: Baseline Tail-Risk Recall Metrics ($risk@k\%$)

Model	**risk@1%**	**risk@3%**	**risk@5%**	**risk@10%**	**risk@20%**
Linear Regression	0.0171	0.0614	0.1126	0.1877	0.3857
Ridge	0.0171	0.0614	0.1126	0.1877	0.3857
Lasso	0.0137	0.0751	0.1058	0.1945	0.4061
MLP Regressor	0.0102	0.0819	0.1399	0.2184	0.4437
Random Forest	0.0102	0.0887	0.1297	0.2321	0.4437
Extra Trees	0.0000	0.1024	0.1365	0.2082	0.4334
SVR	0.0034	0.0785	0.1160	0.1945	0.4164
XGBoost	0.0102	0.0887	0.1297	0.2218	0.4300

minimize regression error. Notably, the proposed **MLP-Att-Res** architecture achieves an MSE on the order of 10^{-6}, which is a two-order-of-magnitude improvement over the plain MLP baseline. This high precision is crucial for the subsequent integration with quantum bottlenecks, as it ensures that the classical encoder provides a high-fidelity feature representation.

Table S4: Deep Learning Regression Metrics (MSE scaled by 10^{-6})

Model	R^2	**MAE**	**MSE** ($\times 10^{-6}$)
MLP Plain	0.9988	0.0040	58.62
MLP ResNet	0.9991	0.0039	45.91
MLP Att-Plain	0.9999	0.0015	4.40
MLP Att-Res	**0.9999**	**0.0011**	**2.26**
CNN1D Plain	0.9998	0.0024	12.17
CNN1D ResNet	0.9998	0.0023	10.88
NAF1D Plain	0.9998	0.0021	9.56
NAF1D Res	0.9998	0.0021	9.71

Table S5: Deep Learning Classification Metrics (Prevalence-Matched)

Model	**Accuracy**	**Precision**	**Recall**	**F1**	**AUC**
MLP Plain	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6940
MLP ResNet	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6969
MLP Att-Plain	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6975
MLP Att-Res	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6972
CNN1D ResNet	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6974
NAF1D Res	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6965

Table S6: Deep Learning Tail-Risk Recall Metrics ($risk@k\%$)

Model	**risk@1%**	**risk@3%**	**risk@5%**	**risk@10%**	**risk@20%**
MLP Plain	0.0096	0.0289	0.0257	0.0209	0.0211
MLP ResNet	0.0096	0.0279	0.0251	0.0206	0.0212
MLP Att-Plain	0.0096	0.0300	0.0257	0.0209	0.0209
MLP Att-Res	**0.0096**	**0.0300**	**0.0257**	**0.0209**	**0.0209**
CNN1D ResNet	0.0096	0.0289	0.0257	0.0209	0.0211
NAF1D Res	0.0096	0.0311	0.0257	0.0212	0.0209

S1.3 Quantum-Classical Hybrid Model Performance

Tables S7, S8, and S9 explore the performance of various Quantum Neural Network (QNN) configurations. The results highlight the efficacy of the **QNN_Bottleneck** approach, which places the parameterized quantum circuit (PQC) as a latent representation layer. While these models possess significantly fewer parameters than their purely classical counterparts, they maintain high fidelity in risk intensity estimation. Specifically, the trainable quantum feature maps consistently outperform fixed-mapping variants, suggesting that gradient-based optimization of quantum gates is essential for capturing the complex manifold of wildfire risk data.

Table S7: Quantum Hybrid Regression Metrics (MSE scaled by 10^{-6})

Model Variant	R^2	**MAE**	**MSE** ($\times 10^{-6}$)
QNN_Bottleneck	**0.9985**	**0.0058**	**71.47**
QNN_FixedMap	0.9967	0.0086	160.17
QNN_QuantumTail	0.9952	0.0112	235.15
QNN_FixedMap_QTail	0.9945	0.0117	269.74

Table S8: Quantum Hybrid Classification Metrics (Prevalence-Matched)

Model Variant	**Accuracy**	**Precision**	**Recall**	**F1**	**AUC**
QNN_Bottleneck	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6946
QNN_FixedMap	0.9814	0.0102	0.0102	0.0102	0.6938
QNN_QuantumTail	0.9813	0.0068	0.0068	0.0068	0.6902
QNN_FixedMap_QTail	0.9812	0.0034	0.0034	0.0034	0.6871

Table S9: Quantum Hybrid Tail-Risk Recall Metrics ($risk@k\%$)

Model Variant	**risk@1%**	**risk@3%**	**risk@5%**	**risk@10%**	**risk@20%**
QNN_Bottleneck	**0.0096**	**0.0311**	**0.0257**	**0.0203**	**0.0206**
QNN_FixedMap	0.0096	0.0257	0.0251	0.0209	0.0199
QNN_QuantumTail	0.0096	0.0279	0.0283	0.0215	0.0201
QNN_FixedMap_QTail	0.0096	0.0300	0.0276	0.0203	0.0204

.3 Model Storage and Deployment Efficiency

One of the primary advantages of the proposed Quantum Hybrid models is their deployment efficiency on resource-constrained edge devices. Table S10 compares the serialized model file sizes (`.pth`) across all 12 evaluated architectures, derived from physical disk storage measurements.

The results demonstrate an order-of-magnitude reduction in storage requirements when transitioning from classical deep learning to quantum-enhanced representations. Specifically, our champion classical model, `MLPAttRes` (117.21 KB), is approximately **21 times larger** than the `QNN_QuantumTail` (5.38 KB). Even the most complex quantum variant, `QNN_Bottleneck`, remains 85.5% smaller than the optimized classical attention-residual backbone. This significant compression validates the hypothesis that the Hilbert space provides a higher information density per parameter, enabling high-precision risk modeling with a minimal memory footprint suitable for real-time edge deployment.

Table S10: Comprehensive Model Serialization Sizes (Serialized PyTorch Weights)

Architecture Category	**Model Name**	**File Size (KB)**
Classical Convolutional	CNN1DPlain	85.43
	CNN1DResNet	136.39
Classical Attention/NAF	NAF1DPlain	122.30
	NAF1DRes	122.22
	MLPAttPlain	49.95
	MLPAttRes	**117.21**
Classical Baseline	MLPPlain	46.83
	MLPResNet	114.22
Quantum Hybrid (Ours)	QNN_Bottleneck	16.95
	QNN_FixedMap	16.91
	QNN_FixedMap_QuantumTail	5.65
	QNN_QuantumTail	**5.38**

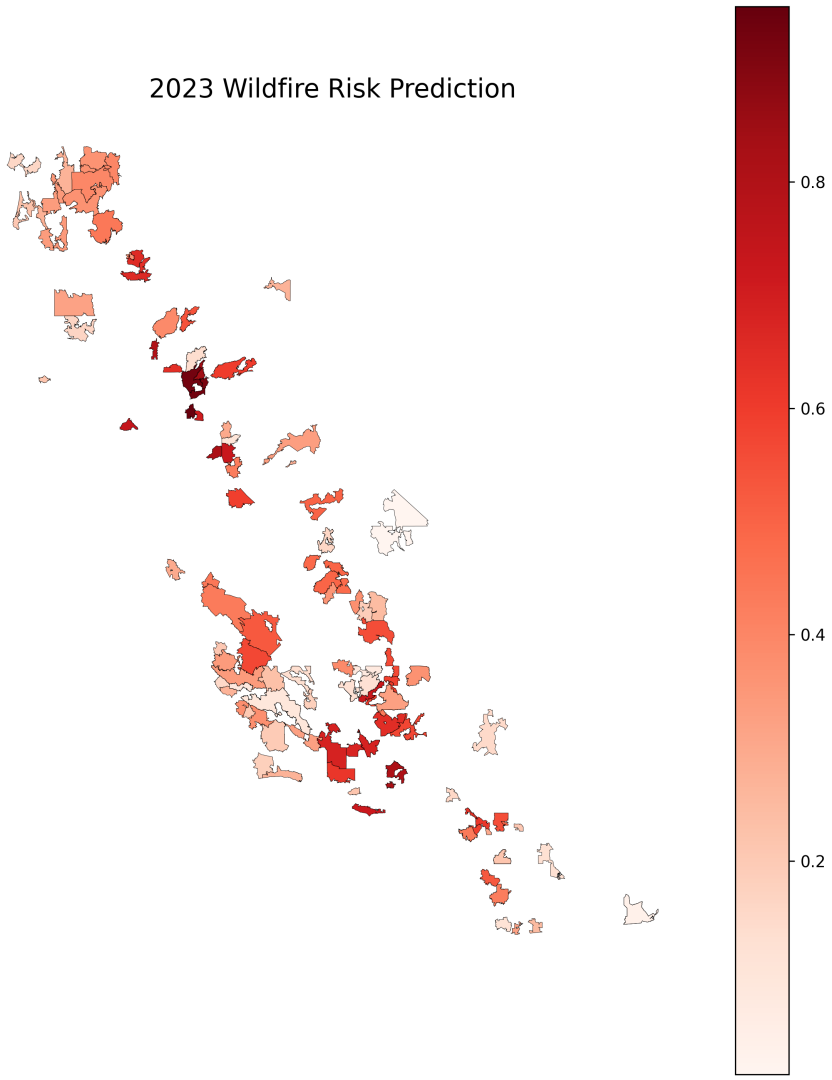

Figure 2: Choropleth map of predicted 2023 wildfire risk intensities (λ) aggregated by ZIP Code Tabulation Areas (ZCTA). The model robustly forecasts regional vulnerability using historical climate averages.